ADMed SPECIALIST CLINIC

CARE OF YOUR AV-FISTULA

You have had a very important procedure that will allow you to have safe and comfortable dialysis. The fistula takes about 8 weeks to mature before it can be used.

DOs

1. See the surgeon at Clinic for inspection of the operation site once weekly for the next four weeks.
2. See the nurses at your dialysis center for change of the dressing every other day until it is no longer necessary to cover the wound. Usually, there will be no need to remove stitches.
3. Squeeze the small soft ball you have been given as often as possible. It will help in the maturity of the fistula.
4. Report to the Clinic immediately (Tel:0556996422/0243560080) if you notice any unusual problem like pain, swelling, bleeding or difficulty in moving the arm with the fistula. Do not wait for the weekly inspection.
5. Please take the painkiller and antibiotics as prescribed.

DON'Ts

1. Do not bend the arm with the fistula. Keep it straight most of the time.
2. Try not to sleep on that arm until the fistula is mature.
3. Do not allow any form of band/tie on the arm where the fistula is located.
4. Do not lift any heavy loads with the fistula arm.
5. Do not check your blood pressure (BP) on the arm with the fistula.
6. No blood sample should be taken on the arm with the fistula.
7. No IV line or drip should be set on the arm with the fistula.

Other information

1. Dialysis should not be done on the day of the fistula operation. It leads to excessive bleeding from the fistula wound due to the heparin used during the dialysis.
2. If dialysis is done on the first day after the fistula operation, your nurses may still not use heparin because some patients may still bleed.
3. As much as possible, avoid dehydration from conditions like diarrhea and vomiting, because dehydration may cause the collapse of the fistula.
4. If at any time there is poor function of the fistula, your doctors will refer you back to see us.
5. If the fistula is not functioning well, you may be rescheduled for another fistula operation.

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